Healthy Home Matcher Scoring Rubric

Demand Reality & Problem Severity

Product Definition

We are building Healthy Home Matcher for renters and homebuyers who want a home that supports their health, lifestyle, and medical needs, but struggle to compare health-related factors across properties. It uses AI to grade each home across two dimensions: preventative health and medical access, so users can choose a home that supports active living, healthy eating, environmental safety, and access to relevant care.

Core Problem

Housing search is built around price, size, photos, schools, and commute. It rarely answers a more personal question: **will living here support or work against my health?**

The pain is real because people make high-cost, hard-to-reverse housing decisions while manually piecing together health signals from disconnected sources: air quality maps, hazard maps, grocery searches, walkability tools, hospital directories, and condition-specific provider searches.

Healthy Homes Grading System

Score	What It Measures	Example Signals
Preventative Score / Active Health	How well the home environment supports proactive healthy living.	Air quality; pollution; walkability; fire, flood, earthquake, and heat risk; access to fresh food and grocery stores; parks or green space.
Medical Access Score / Existing Conditions	How well the location supports people with specific medical needs.	Cancer treatment centers; diabetes care; kidney dialysis centers; allergy and asthma specialists; hospitals, pharmacies, and clinics.

Target Users

- **Health-conscious home seekers:** They want daily life to be easier to live well: walk more, eat better, avoid poor air, and reduce environmental exposure.
- **People managing existing medical needs:** They need practical access to relevant care, such as oncology, diabetes care, dialysis, allergy care, hospitals, and pharmacies.
- **Caregivers and families:** They are choosing homes not just for themselves, but for children, older adults, or family members with specific health needs.

What Users Do Today vs. How This Helps

Today	With Healthy Home Matcher
Search homes on Zillow, Redfin, Apartments.com, or Realtor.com, then open separate tabs for maps, clinics, hazards, groceries, pollution, and walkability.	Compare homes using a unified health-fit view that explains preventative health, medical access, strengths, risks, and tradeoffs.
Rely on scattered public data, agent comments, visual inspection, and personal guesswork.	Use AI to turn fragmented data into clear, personalized scores and plain-English explanations.
Often discover health or access problems after moving, when switching costs are high.	Surface hidden health tradeoffs before signing a lease or making an offer.

Potential Impact

- **Social impact:** Makes health-relevant housing information usable for everyday people, especially families, caregivers, older adults, and people with medical needs.
- **Business impact:** Creates a differentiated health intelligence layer for housing search, with potential use by consumers, real estate platforms, relocation firms, agents, healthcare organizations, and insurers.
- **Technical impact:** Uses AI to combine environmental, neighborhood, property, and care-access data into explainable, personalized property scores rather than generic neighborhood rankings.

Judge-Ready Takeaway

Healthy Home Matcher helps people stop treating health as an afterthought in housing search. It makes health fit visible before they commit to where they live by scoring homes on both proactive healthy living and access to condition-specific medical care.

Recommended demo focus: Show two homes with similar rent and commute, then reveal how they differ on walkability, grocery access, air quality, hazard exposure, and proximity to relevant care.

Target Customer & Market Scope

Category Fit

Target customer: renters, homebuyers, caregivers, and families who need health to be part of the housing decision, not an afterthought after price, size, photos, schools, and commute.

Core market insight: people already make housing decisions with major health consequences, but the relevant signals are scattered across environmental data, hazard maps, food access tools, and medical provider searches.

Product Positioning

Healthy Home Matcher is a health intelligence layer for housing search. It uses AI to compare homes across two practical scores: a Preventative / Active Health Score and a Medical Access Score. The goal is not to replace listing platforms; it is to help users decide whether the homes they like will support how they need to live.

Clear User

User Segment	What They Care About	Why They Use It
Health-conscious movers	Walkability, fresh food, clean air, parks, lower environmental exposure.	They want a home that makes healthy routines easier, not harder.
Families and caregivers	Children, older adults, or relatives whose daily health depends on place.	They need a faster way to compare health tradeoffs across homes.
People managing medical needs	Condition-specific care access, pharmacies, hospitals, transportation burden.	They need to know whether a location supports ongoing care before moving.

Evidence the Problem Exists Beyond One Case

Evidence	What the Data Says	Why It Matters
Chronic needs are common	CDC reports that three in four American adults have at least one chronic condition, and over half have two or more. [1]	A large share of users are not choosing homes as average users; health constraints change what “good location” means.
Air quality affects millions	The American Lung Association reports that 152.3 million Americans, or 44%, live in places with failing grades for unhealthy ozone or particle pollution. [2]	Air quality is a mainstream housing factor for families, children, older adults, and people with asthma or allergies.
Place shapes behavior	CDC says the built environment can influence physical activity and healthy eating. [3]	Walkability, sidewalks, parks, transit, and grocery access are not lifestyle extras; they shape daily health behavior.
Food access is measurable	USDA’s Food Access Research Atlas maps supermarket accessibility and food access at census-tract level. [4]	Healthy diet depends partly on whether fresh food is realistically accessible from the home.
Care access varies by location	HRSA tracks Health Professional Shortage Areas for primary care, dental health, and mental health, with daily updates. [5]	Medical access is uneven; condition-specific search can help users avoid care deserts.
Hazard risk is local	FEMA’s National Risk Index provides census-tract data on risk, expected annual loss, social vulnerability, and resilience for 18 natural hazards. [6]	Flood, fire, earthquake, heat, and other hazards can change the health and financial risk of a home.
Housing decisions happen at scale	The Census Bureau reported that 11.8% of the U.S. population moved to a different residence in 2024. [7]	Even at historically lower mobility levels, millions of people face housing decisions each year.

Novel Use of AI & Creative Problem Solving

- **Personalized scoring:** Weights factors differently based on user goals or medical needs, such as asthma, diabetes, dialysis, cancer treatment, allergies, or general active living.
- **Data synthesis:** Combines fragmented public signals across environment, hazards, food access, walkability, and medical access into one comparable view.
- **Plain-English explanations:** Explains why one home scores better than another instead of showing a black-box number.
- **Decision support:** Generates next-step questions for agents, landlords, inspectors, or care providers before the user commits.

Differentiation

Current Alternative	Healthy Home Matcher Difference
Zillow, Redfin, Apartments.com	Strong listing search, but weak on personalized health fit.
Google Maps and provider search	Shows nearby places, but does not interpret health tradeoffs or compare homes.
Walkability and food-access tools	Useful single-factor signals, but not connected to medical access or environmental risk.
EPA, USDA, HRSA, FEMA public data	Valuable but fragmented; Healthy Home Matcher turns the data into a user-facing decision layer.

Why This Matters Enough to Use

Housing decisions are expensive, emotional, and hard to reverse. A bad health fit can mean more driving for groceries or care, less daily movement, higher exposure to pollution or hazards, missed appointments, caregiver stress, and worse quality of life. Healthy Home Matcher earns usage because it answers a question users already care about but cannot easily answer today: will living here make it easier or harder to stay healthy?

Judge-Ready Takeaway

People already compare homes by price, square footage, schools, and commute. Healthy Home Matcher adds the missing health-fit layer: active living, fresh food access, environmental safety, and condition-specific medical care. That makes the product differentiated, evidence-based, and practical for a large set of users making high-stakes housing decisions.

Solution Fit & Product Design

Technical Execution & Demo Proof

Differentiation and Investment Readiness

Category Fit

Investment thesis: Healthy Home Matcher is not another listing search tool. It is a health-fit layer for housing decisions, helping users understand whether a home supports active living, environmental safety, healthy food access, and condition-specific medical care.

Why it is meaningfully different: Current tools show price, photos, bedrooms, schools, commute, and nearby places. Healthy Home Matcher turns fragmented health, environmental, hazard, food, and care-access data into personalized, explainable scores.

Important, Durable, and Meaningfully Different

Signal	Fact-Based Evidence	Investment Relevance
Chronic needs are widespread	CDC reports that three in four U.S. adults have at least one chronic condition, and more than half have two or more. [1]	Many users have health constraints that make location, daily access, and care proximity materially important.
Air quality is not niche	American Lung Association reports 152.3 million Americans, or 44%, live in places with failing grades for unhealthy ozone or particle pollution. [2]	Air quality belongs in housing decisions for families, older adults, and users with asthma, allergies, or respiratory risk.
Medical access is uneven	HRSA reports that about 20% of the U.S. population resides in primary medical care Health Professional Shortage Areas. [3]	Care access varies by location; users with ongoing conditions need to see this before moving.
Digital housing search is massive	Zillow reported 221 million average monthly unique users and 2.1 billion visits across its apps and sites in Q4 2025. [4]	The behavior already exists. The opportunity is to add a missing decision layer, not invent a new market habit.

Why This Approach Is Better Than Existing Alternatives

Alternative	What It Solves	What Healthy Home Matcher Adds
Zillow / Redfin / Apartments.com	Listings, photos, price, beds, baths, commute, market activity.	Personalized health fit and explainable tradeoffs before a lease or offer.
Google Maps / provider search	Nearby grocery stores, hospitals, clinics, parks, pharmacies.	AI interpretation: what those nearby places mean for this user and this condition.
Walk Score	Walkability based on routes to amenities and pedestrian factors such as block length and intersection density. [8]	Broader health scoring across food access, environment, hazards, care access, and condition-specific needs.
EPA / USDA / FEMA / HRSA public data	Strong data, but fragmented and technical.	A consumer-facing decision layer that maps public data to real homes and explains the score.

Novel Use of AI

Best framing: AI does not simply find homes. It translates public health, environmental, hazard, food-access, walkability, and care-access data into personalized housing health intelligence.

- **Data normalization:** Converts different datasets and distance-based signals into comparable property-level inputs.
- **Personalized weighting:** Adjusts the score based on the user profile, such as active living, asthma, allergies, diabetes, dialysis, cancer care, or caregiver support.
- **Tradeoff reasoning:** Explains why a home can be strong for preventative health but weak for medical access, or vice versa.
- **Actionable guidance:** Generates questions for agents, landlords, inspectors, or care providers before the user commits.

What Makes It Hard to Copy

Defensibility Factor	Why It Matters
Health-fit scoring model	A generic neighborhood score is easy to copy. A transparent, condition-specific scoring model is harder because it requires user-specific weighting and careful explanation.
Multi-source data pipeline	FEMA, USDA, EPA, HRSA, Walk Score-style signals, and local provider data each have different formats, geographic resolution, update cycles, and confidence levels. [5][6][7][8]
Explainability and trust layer	Health-related housing guidance needs source transparency, confidence notes, and disclaimers so users understand what the score can and cannot prove.
User feedback loop	As users compare homes and adjust priorities, the product can learn which tradeoffs matter most by condition, household type, and geography.
Workflow placement	The product can become the “check this home before I commit” step between browsing a listing and signing a lease or making an offer.

What the Next Version Should Prove

Narrow proof target: Users will check a home health-fit report before committing to a lease or purchase, and the score will change their confidence, shortlist, or questions.

MVP Test	What to Build	Strong Signal
Scope	One metro area, 25-50 real properties, two user profiles: active-health seeker and asthma/allergy-sensitive user.	Users can compare real options without the product becoming too broad too early.
Core output	Preventative / Active Health Score, Medical Access Score, top strengths, top risks, and plain-English explanation.	Users understand the score and can explain why one home is a better health fit.
Decision impact	Ask users to compare three homes and choose which they would pursue.	30-40% say the report changes their shortlist, confidence, or next questions.
Willingness to use/pay	Test a one-time health-fit report or premium comparison view.	Users say they would use it before signing and some would pay $10-$25 for a report.
Trust	Show sources, data resolution, confidence level, and caveats.	Users trust the explanation even when the score reveals tradeoffs rather than a perfect answer.

Judge-Ready Takeaway

Healthy Home Matcher is differentiated because it makes health fit visible in housing search. The product is important because where someone lives shapes movement, food access, pollution exposure, hazard risk, and medical access. It is durable because chronic conditions, environmental risk, and provider shortages are persistent and location-dependent. The approach is better than existing alternatives because it does the hard integration work for the user: it turns fragmented public data into personalized, explainable scores. The next version should prove that users understand, trust, and act on those scores before committing to a home.

Likely Judge / Investor Challenges

- **Can Zillow just copy this?** Zillow can add more filters, but the defensible layer is condition-specific health reasoning, transparent scoring, and a trusted data pipeline across health, environment, hazards, food, and care access.
- **Is this medical advice?** No. It is housing decision support. The app should surface location-based health factors, cite sources, show confidence levels, and clearly state that users should consult clinicians for medical decisions.
- **Is the data good enough?** Good enough for directional decision support, not clinical certainty. The product should be transparent about geographic resolution, recency, and confidence.

Sources

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[5] FEMA, National Risk Index Census Tracts: https://www.arcgis.com/home/item.html?id=9da4eeb936544335a6db0cd7a8448a51

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[8] Walk Score, Methodology: https://www.walkscore.com/methodology.shtml